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Virginia Board of Education, Special Committee on Standards of Accreditation, Wednesday, July 22, 2020

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GZ5k1Xr-TQw
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:43] - Hi, Shelly. - Hey, Emily, how are you? - I'm good, how are you? - Doing okay, I'm gonna see if I can fix my camera. - Oh, that's okay, I can at least see most of you.

[00:01:00] - See my mouth. - Yeah, and just so you know, Emily Durst is working on taking us live so that we're ready to go right at two, which is why I've already started screen share.

[00:01:11] - Okay, great, thank you.

[00:03:47] - Hello. - Hey, guys, how are you? - Pam, hey, Keisha. Just to let you guys know, we actually got set up early and we're already live streaming. We just wanted to have it set up so we didn't have to wait around.

[00:04:04] So we'll just give folks a couple more minutes to sign on since we still have about six minutes till we begin. And then, Keisha, I'll turn it over to you when we're ready to get started. I'll be able to do the screen share whenever I need to. Yeah, what will happen, I will, once we get to that part where you need to screen share the work plan, i'll take this down and give you screen sharing right so you can pop that up yeah i'll have that and i'm also going to reference uh powerpoint the original powerpoint that was presented to us

[00:04:37] at the i do have that linked in this one as well so if i need to click to that or pull it up i can do that or if you've already got it ready to go you can share it too yeah yeah i already know what slides i want but that'll work too it'll be a good backup plan either way great i did have one other question but i know we're live i didn't know if i could ask about the september meeting didn't we pre-preliminary talk about a topic yeah so we have talked about doing an august meeting as well as a september meeting um september what we discussed at the thursday meeting in june was that we would

[00:05:16] try to have the september meeting coincide with our normal meetings but that since the board didn't meet in august we would add an august committee meeting yeah i was talking about i thought we had you and i had an offline or with doc with a dr lane a conversation about who might be a presenter i'm talking about the presenters didn't we have somebody potentially lined up for september and we're going to talk about august as a part of this um i think we tossed around a couple of ideas but i don't think that we settled on it but we had talked about um potentially bringing an education

[00:05:52] commission of the states in august to provide kind of that national perspective overview um and then in september we talked about potentially having some of the folks from the accreditation task force come and talk about some of their recommendations that they had and then we have a whole long list that we talked about but hadn't decided who and where quite yet right and that's all good i just wanted to i'm just recalling all my facts and points so as i'm getting my

[00:06:24] thoughts together so that's that's all good that's all i needed all right folks as you're signing on just want to let everyone know that we are live streaming on youtube we went ahead and got that set up so that we're ready to go um as soon as we have everyone on the line and it looks like we

[00:07:03] have Dr. Lane and uh Mrs. Davis Vaught and a number of staff but we do not have um Dr. Wilson or Dr. Duran yet good afternoon Dr. Peckson excited for this uh meeting like we saw a few

[00:07:35] minutes good afternoon I've minimized my screen so I have no idea who that was that was Dr. Lane yep hello again that you that would have been one of my top two guesses hello i was looking

[00:08:00] over the agenda sorry i was refreshing my memory on that all right we've had dr wilson join us and

[00:09:09] looks like we're still waiting on dr duran emily is the agenda built as part of these slides

[00:09:25] yes ma'am it is so is it my cue or your cue or so i don't see dr duran yet but it is two o'clock

[00:10:32] so um as the chair you're welcome to kind of kick kick things off um and go ahead and get us started well uh i'll go ahead and say and i guess kicking off our official second committee meeting that i don't I'm not all well versed in all the formal lingo that usually goes with the formalities of being a chair so I'm going to run this just like I've been running every other shipyard meeting I've been on today yesterday tomorrow all last weekend and so on but first want to thank everybody

[00:11:09] for for just getting back together I'm excited to have this discussion what I'd like to do is just kind of lay out what I propose would be our plan for today, our approach for today, and most likely moving forward for the next couple of meetings. I have had some time to prep for this and talking with Emily and Dr. Lane and also just kind of reading some other documentation. So what I'd like to do is first, you know, obviously we're going to go through the agenda and prove the minutes and all that. But I'd like to spend the first half of the meeting really kind of recapping

[00:11:47] back some information from last meeting, revisiting our working plan. There's a couple of loose ends on that that I've now that I've gotten some additional data that we've been provided. I want to kind of bring some context to that data that I saw and maybe align that to some discussions around the working plan. So I want to spend the first half of the meeting talking about that, but I really want to allow some time on the back half of the meeting for some education, because I really think that's going to be a key component of this committee's work and review is

[00:12:24] just really making sure we've got a solid foundation of understanding perspectives and decisions that were made and standards that were put in place and the whys behind them, the five whys behind them. So I want to have that kind of balance of this meeting and my plan was moving forward probably for the next few months would be very much like that a very active working part with a partial with a balance with a more educational informational uh presentational part so with that we can jump right into the approval of the minutes before we actually get into the the working plan piece and so um i'm assuming that's something that i facilitate emily so

[00:13:05] yes and if also if we can um since we are virtual and i didn't put it on here but since we are virtual um let's do a just quick roll call of the board members that are here and then we'll call for a motion to approve both the june 17th and june 18th minutes okay so we'll start with the roll call uh starting with um miss pam davis vault i'm here dr wilson here i did not tell if

[00:13:43] Dr. Duran joined yet and any i don't see him on but we can if you just hop on we can make sure to to grab his attendance later okay do i have to eye my own attendance that's okay i got you okay all right and so now for the approval of uh the minutes from both the june 17th uh initial meeting of this commit committee where we got a briefing on the history

[00:14:18] of the accreditation the standard accreditation and then our working meeting on june 18th both meeting minutes were provided as part of the board's reading material on our prep material for this review is there a motion to approve those minutes so make a motion oh sorry jamil Pam, I'll take Pam's motion and it was a second from Jamel. Yes, thank you. Thank you. So with that, we'll move forward with the next part of the agenda, which was to continue the discussion on

[00:14:56] the working plan. I would like to screen share at this point, Emily, if I could. Yep. One thing, there's about, there's, in reviewing the working plan and reviewing a lot of the documentation that we were provided I don't know if you get the board picked up on it but Emily in the department put together a good a good solid summary like a play-by-play history of kind of how the accreditation standards became came to be as they are today it's a very detailed document very helpful and then

[00:15:35] they also provided two summaries of public hearings that were held and where the subject matter relative to the standards were addressed it provided some good feedback there um so in reviewing those documents and then also going back to the original presentation that we were giving given by miss loving rider um back on the 17th i believe i just said um uh relative to the history of the whole process i went back to that document and i was reconciling that against our working plan and so um i'm going to you're welcome to screen share um yeah i'm gonna do that

[00:16:15] right now i'm assuming you can see the working plan thumbs up yep so uh i don't i don't know if that helps to make it more visible but uh four things that i thought was important for us to focus on doing one of which will you know kind of help inform this working plan session but the the other three

really will kind of help our uh inform not only the information session we're going to get today but what future ones we think we should definitely prioritize and make sure we

[00:16:49] hear from to really inform our thoughts um the objective was something that we left um incomplete if you remember the part that's that's red right here that said validate efficient progress towards original intended outcomes we left that we left that highlighted and i i had in parentheses review later because I think we knew that we wanted to be cautiously aware of making sure we very accurately defined what our objectives were that you know we kind of questioned are we really here to validate something that's that that that just just really just got started how much

[00:17:25] how much can we actually do that and so in revisiting that that that objective and then reviewing a lot of the material that we've been given one thing that I wanted to uh reference to the team and kind of bring back around and i'm going to switch my screen share again and just kind of see how talented i am to quickly navigate to this other one wow my team would be so proud of me um if you guys recall these were the slides that were part of the original slide deck that

[00:18:00] we are presented as far as the historical landscape of the standards and nine and ten when i reviewed that the second go around really stood out to me because 9 and 10 talks about basically the characteristics that when the original board members and the original department members and subject matter experts were kind of plotting their path forward and trying to figure out what changes need to be considered as part of this revision to the standards. This is what

[00:18:34] their North Star was. These two slides stood out to me as these were the boundaries by which they were trying to hold themselves accountable. They said this was going to be the characteristics of the accreditation, that they were, of course, going to consider what other states felt deemed were relevant. But the importance of multiple indicators was that it was going to encourage advancement to next level performance. It was going to recognize continuous levels of improvement.

[00:19:01] It's going to indicate strengths and potential points of improvement. And then the matrix basis system had said it was going to each of those multiple indicators would be assigned a performance measure. When I combine that with the next slide we were shared is that this was the criteria they used at that time to help them define how they were going to select accreditation indicators. This is kind of what was their foundation of what they were going to anchor themselves in and they wanted to make sure these accreditation standards were uh research indicated

[00:19:40] research indicates metric is related to academic performance that data for metrics are reliable and valid that measurable is modifiable through school level policies and practices i'm not going to read all these to you but i really want to get it to you is the intent of why i'm sharing these i feel like if these were the original anchors of thought that they are standards that they they establish themselves to identify these accreditation indicators, and we're just now kind of out of the gate and assessing a new system that's really being launched.

[00:20:17] When we go back to really trying to define our outcome or what our really our scope of work is, I feel like it's just maybe validating, doing a pulse check against some of these original characteristics that the the original thought leaders designed and so i feel like maybe that's what our charter really is about it's not about looking to change anything like we've said it's not about looking to validate anything it's more about saying hey this is what we set out for or is there anything out there that's either that's indicating to us that we've gone off course

[00:20:53] already with some of these early criteria so i'll pause there for a minute because i i just wanted to kind of open the discussion first with where i feel like we need to start is a consensus around what our core objective is be sure would you go back to the previous slide uh one there thank you so i think i i agree that the criteria that you have or you showed us on the the next slide that

[00:21:30] that really is a that's a place to start because it will allow us to determine um to check the assumption that those indicators really would allow or would represent being these characteristics i do think the matrix based system so the assignment of performance level um i'm sorry if you go to the next slide um the assignment of performance level um thinking about that one too

[00:22:06] perhaps is, in addition to these criteria, maybe something to consider. I feel like the others kind of are encapsulated. The other two, the top two, the research-based and the multiple measures are captured in this set of seven, but then the matrix piece may be something to consider as an additional item to look at. Yes, I'm speaking in the yes and, not the either or, but yeah, I did see them as separate things.

[00:22:40] I just felt like these two slides, just even in title, indicate that their criteria are boundaries by which they've built a plan upon. So yes, and I only brought this, again, I'm bringing this up just for bringing the team back to that, making sure as we're starting off, as far as answering the question, what problem are we really trying to solve?

[00:23:08] to say that there's a problem but what really are we what does finish look like um it's easier to answer when you know what your original intention was and so that's kind of where i said if i considered what's on those slides what we're really doing is we're conducting some sort of initial kind of pulse check of that criteria uh that was used when selecting the accreditation indicators um so i wanted to just uh continue the dialogue around this you know better framing out the objective if we feel like we're we're closer to to right than what we were the first

[00:23:45] time we talked about it yes on the objective the sentence prior to the one you just read conduct data available since implementation as well as current state affairs might those be merged a little bit then if what we're doing is i mean it's almost repetitive to say to me the condition conduct initial pulse check because in that initial pulse check wouldn't we be looking at data

[00:24:22] when we look at the current state of affairs yes i think i love the what you put in red and what you were just referring to the last two slides i'm just suggesting making the objective of uh more can you know combine the elements of it right so if i'm hearing you correctly that this sentence almost becomes irrelevant because the statement stands on itself that that's part of that right be considered as part of that process right right yeah so you know i don't wanna we don't have to belabor it i just i just for me and i don't know how much how many people on the team have had a

[00:24:58] chance to read any other information um but for me i know that that that you know really kind of getting a better understanding of of the historical historical aspect of it and kind of how things came to be made me kind of get a better feel for kind of where where where it is in the deployment process and there's only but so much really um that that at this point we would want to disrupt as much as assess and really inform ourselves if there's if there's something that's on the trail of perpetuating a negative outcome that we didn't originally intend so so dr peck's note that that

[00:25:37] last comment resonates with me because as we are a set or are doing this pulse check against the indicators and in the meeting last time we talked about hearing from division and building leaders about you know kind of what the operationalization has looked like if we are learning things and I think in that this whole process setting out markers for what we want to continue to have updates on or have information provided to us on so that we are not at whatever point finding ourselves having to start from the beginning but rather we've already we've started collecting data

[00:26:16] that we can use as a touch point for moving forward and making adjustments as necessary. So I think that that's going to, your comment's going to be highly relative to why I think spending a balanced portion of our time getting information, and when I say in getting information education, I mean really making sure we know we're asking the right questions to capture the right data. Maybe not only for this engagement, but for future analysis of this, you know, of this

[00:26:47] of this process, but agreed, completely agreed. May I ask a question? Sure. And this may be for Dr. Lane or any other members of staff who are on the call. I would imagine that we, that the department, when you look at those criteria, that the department has already started collecting data or has this idea anyway. And so if the department is collecting information, is that not and it may be that in subsequent presentations we will have some of that fed back to us that we

[00:27:25] know at this point but it would be uh good for me to hear or to be reminded what is the department doing i guess at this point to collect information around those criteria already and if that comes at a different time in the agenda dr pexton let me know sorry dr lena cut you off no no i certainly we we have the ability to sorry dr pexton do you want me to answer that no you're good okay the um certainly we have the ability to produce all these data i think that today's meeting is really to level set what you're looking for and then the department will be more than prepared to make

[00:28:03] presentations on all of this so to to that point you know one thing that i've you know that i think is kind of obvious is that there's a lot of information that informed not only how the the standards of accreditation looks today but there's just there's a lot of data that that is

[00:28:36] being newly captured or will need to be captured in order to assess its effectiveness and so to be caught to be aware of you know what's the most relevant data for us to understand based on what where our objective is, I think is very important. And so knowing now that we're trying, we're trying to really just kind of do a pulse check against certain criteria. I think that that is one thing that helps kind of indicate to us, well, what other information might we want to learn from that the department could help, could help provide. I also think, and I'm going to move on to the other three

[00:29:14] sections of the, of the work and plan that I think will lend itself to the rest of the back half of our meeting. I also think that as we've had some discussions in our early meetings, you know, I took a stab at kind of dumping some of the statements that were made or questions that were asked into either some facts or assumptions or considerations, you know, just kind of based on how they were presented. And then also as a result of that, we also started to identify some additional key tasks, some things that we wanted to consider for the future. And so when I review

[00:29:52] all of this, you know, there could easily be like 10 different presentations that we could ask for in some of this stuff that's up here. And in the essence of respecting the department's resources and time and attention on the right things, you know, on one side, I want to respect what they propose would be a good place to start, which they're doing a great job at, and we're going to hear some about that. But on the

other side of that, you know, I also want this team to have some consensus around what information do we need to know or understand more about that's going to help us better perform the objective of this committee.

[00:30:31] I'm going to pause there for a second. Does that make sense? Because there's a whole lot on here that we want to know more about. And I want to spend some time reviewing these things and starting to really talk through some sort of sense of what's a priority for us to hear about in the next couple of months of meetings and what really really is not is that fair yeah i'm hoping emily's like you know

[00:31:02] okay so for example um one comment that had come up in a previous meeting was talking about that there was two indicators that did not make the cut score in the original uh process of developing the standards you know maybe in as part of some other presentation emily or dr lang you might be able to tell talk to this maybe in part of some other presentation we can get some some indication or implications of that or why but obviously somebody on the board was very interested in

[00:31:37] understanding why that was the case um so stuff like that to me is where i feel like we need to talk through how do we either address it put it on the backboard burner or make sure it's going to be in a future presentation sounds good and i i would say certainly we can provide that i just for being that three of the four of you weren't here when this happened in 2017 I think it's important for you to note that I was also not here when these determinations were made and so I'll be learning some of the the process with you I've been here through the full implementation but the

[00:32:14] but the the reasons I only heard as a local division superintendent yeah and and I kind of came in the middle of it so I can certainly help provide some context and then we certainly have other staff, Shelly Loving-Rider, Jen Piva-Rena, who can also provide some context to it specific to these two, the student discipline metric as well as the school climate metric. We just didn't have really good data on them yet when we were initially having these discussions, kind of going

[00:32:47] back to some of the board's parameters about having valid and reliable data that, you know, if they couldn't get that they didn't want to have it be part of the matrix that school divisions are held accountable for um and so we can certainly prepare a presentation um either for the august meeting or the september meeting around this data um and what we have now and whether this could be some additional indicators that the the committee and then certainly the board could consider moving forward? So I do want to be clear in the fact that I really was a court reporter at the

[00:33:27] time that these comments were being made. I don't even recall who made them. So the fact that they're on this document and the fact that I'm pulling them out, I'm not necessarily espousing that the committee is hard and fast interested in it. So from my committee members, I'm also looking for some sort of nod or something to say yeah i i need to learn more about that or yes please go embed that or no that was that was i understand why people ask that question but i don't really see that being relative to our focus so i'm kind of looking for some of that consensus feedback too team because part of that that's part of the effort of kind of scrubbing this work down to say

[00:34:06] hey what do we really want to hear about here in the next few months and dr pexton while while folks are thinking about that I'll just maybe add for consideration Virginia has a very outcomes-based model in the way that we approach accreditation and as I've studied accreditation since you decided to take this on I've learned of a lot of other states and many other states use an inputs model now some of

this I don't like I mean there are some states that you know how many books are in your library are part of the you know the system and I wouldn't want that either but what we may

[00:34:45] think about is are there minimum expectations of what we would want from the instructional program that would be part of the accreditation system as well and so i i hope that it's not just those two indicators but that we'll look at a broad range of potential indicators we may want to think about okay no i think that i think that's appropriate i think that's highly there were a number of indicators that folks kind of threw out at the last meeting. Miss Holton talked about

[00:35:19] growth rate indicators for third grade as well as teacher quality and equity indicators. Dr. Mann talked about looking at resources. Dr. Duran talked about an English learner kind of growth indicator. So there were a number I think that we in addition to those two could also add to the list for sure and for me what i was going to say is um without getting specific because we know we all have those specific as individual members but to me the bigger question is what's on the top

[00:35:53] there about what have been the positive outcomes the unintended consequences and where are we missing some groups and so i would love to hear more holistic kind of approach from the department based on data and then we talked about having outside organizations professional organizations right principals teachers etc who would be able to give us their own perspective as well from the subjective side of the data so for me i would really love to see that i don't i'm not owned to answer your question key to those two specific indicators per se even the one i mentioned

[00:36:28] is ell that's a personal one for me but taking the personal side out of this look overall and what has been to your point earlier we're only in this a very short amount of time what have we seen thus far has been unintended. And what have we seen? Some positive and/or negative effects at this moment until you used earlier pulse check. So I feel a little uncomfortable if we go too deep into some specific areas before we do that. That's just how I feel right now.

[00:36:55] So, Emily, you just mentioned a number of different topics. You just hit on them. I was kind of highlighting them as you were touching on them. Because obviously, you guys have been referencing this document as a tool to as an indicator of what a pulse check of us is kind of what we're interested in learning about and you mentioned a couple different things that it sounded like the the the department was already the team was already kind of working on making sure that you responded to us on so maybe i you know maybe we could approach this differently because that's ultimately what i was trying to to to to reconcile is based on everything that was thrown out between

[00:37:32] considerations and additional key tasks how do we give the department a demand signal to say hey here are the presentations we're highly interested in and by the way here are the presentations the the departments already got teed up for us but it sounds like you've already done some of that preliminary legwork so maybe share with us kind of what your intents are intentions are might help this discussion along sure and and i will say the indicators that i kind of threw out there were just topics that the committee as a whole talked about that they wanted to learn more about we have

[00:38:06] not started diving deep on any specific new indicators or possible data for new indicators yet because we did want to get more direction from the committee but one thing that we are going to plan to do if the committee is amenable to it is for the august meeting we were going to bring in education commission of the states that can give a more holistic picture of what's happening across the country as it relates to accreditation um virginia was was very much at the forefront

[00:38:42] um especially when we were developing it so we didn't have a lot of lessons learned from other states but now i think ecs can give us a a bigger picture about what's happening in other states what potential indicators folks may be using have they gone to a matrix approach like virginia and can provide a lot more detail and lessons learned that this committee can can use in their work moving forward i think that would be very beneficial just just to give us a frame of

[00:39:15] reference for that and i agree with that um something that i'm am interested in is um taking a look at the unintended effects on our most vulnerable populations and inequity across all of the vulnerable populations. That's what I'm concerned about is how has this, how are things working actually in the schools? Is that the intended, does that make sense?

[00:39:48] Yeah. How is it working in the schools? Is that the way it was intended to do? And if not, then what steps can we take to right the ship, keeping all the aspects of the child into consideration? Because when we talk about children who are below grade level, and I'm pointing to third grade at the most, in high poverty schools, we're extending, we're stretching to meet the gap of children who lack resources in the home for literacy and math from the time, you know, basically from the time they were born until they come to us in a preschool setting. So we're spending the majority of our time at school playing catch up with the hopes that we can get them to that third

[00:40:28] grade test so that's the lens that I would like to take I don't know if I'm on the right track or not but yeah you're you're actually for me you actually kind of make a question come to mind you know as far as public hearings are concerned I understand how they work as part of our formal adoption process um how do they work as part of committee review or do they meaning again i'm

[00:41:03] doing the pulse check concept to pam's point you know one the only one of the key ways of getting that raw input is asking them so i was just kind of absolutely yeah so we had um a couple different avenues during the 2017 revisions that we would get feedback from those folks that are in schools and in the classroom all the time so we while you know it's somewhat challenging to have a public hearing on every single topic what we would do is we would bring in a handful

[00:41:40] you know four five six for instance principles and have a panel discussion with them and we would make sure that we had geographic differences um that we would have different folks that you know represent you know a title one school or you know just make sure it was a diverse panel in front of the committee so that they could each provide feedback so that is something we could certainly do on this topic um we could work with certainly with all the committee members and with you dr pexton on who might be good to come speak to the committee we could also do that with

[00:42:19] superintendents as well as potentially even teachers um and then certainly one other avenue although you know obviously being virtual right now doesn't lend itself to a ton of public comment but we could ask and solicit written public comment from certain groups every month if we wanted to do that for instance you know at the department we have a listserv that teachers can receive updates from the department on we have a listserv for principals as well and we could

[00:42:54] potentially write to them and and i think it would be helpful maybe to pose some questions on what you they we would want feedback on but that could be another avenue that we explore that we haven't really done before but given just the limitations of where we are right now um may be able to get us a broader sense of feedback probably we probably get a overwhelming sense of feedback just because

right now people got a lot to say about the education system anyways and so it'd be probably surprising what kind of response to that we'd probably get more responses than we wanted

[00:43:29] but but as a result we probably as a result we probably get some good stuff so i i think that be something we certainly would want to consider as far as getting that good empathy data from you know from our from from the from the audience like the black most so you know i also think it would be worthwhile and we certainly touched on this at the meeting in june um to have the different associations represented on different panel discussions each month um you know we could also potentially as we're getting written public comment we could work with the associations to

[00:44:06] to have them kind of collect feedback for us. They often survey their membership, and so that may be another avenue for us to explore, just kind of given that we're not gonna be able to be in person, at least not right now, to make sure that we're giving folks an opportunity to give us their thoughts.

[00:44:26] - So given so many avenues that you've laid out of ways for us to get feedback, I mean, it can almost be too much it's not well absolutely and so i'm certainly interested in all of that so my next thought is how do we kind of figure out a good rhythm by which we get that feedback to inform this committee's work knowing that we're going to be doing this for a little while a good balance between all research factual data and good empathy reality data would be i think a nice a nice dynamic for

[00:45:04] this team so you kind of figure out what that rhythm looks like can i dr pexton can i go take a couple of steps backward i'm sorry to do this but i was thinking about um dr dron's observation um if you scroll back toward the top of your document here where he was talking right there right there um the thinking about mission analysis and then facts and those five bullets that are underneath there. As I think about his comment, you know, maybe if we narrow our, or focus our

[00:45:41] work, and I'm processing out loud, so forgive me, that if we keep at the forefront the top three bullets, these are our questions that we are chasing down, right, that we are, right, that we are constantly looking for. What are the positive outcomes, negative, or the unintended outcomes of this system. And then as we do that, or how we get to positive, negative, and unintended, perhaps as if we focus, and I won't ask you to go back, but on your, when you threw up the two

[00:46:14] slides from last meeting, the characteristics and the criteria, as I'm thinking about it, in the second bullet of the characteristics, it talks about the fact that the notion was that the accreditation would illustrate the importance of multiple indicators in the form of encouraging advancement to the next performance level so those are questions have these indicators encouraged advancement to the next performance level and it and how would we know like what is the what is the

[00:46:51] evidence that we would be looking for that it recognizes continuous levels of improvement what would be the evidence that we're looking for um and then the strengths and potential points of improvement. And then moving on to the criteria, it seems to me that the fourth, fifth, and sixth bullets may be places where we could get that kind of anecdotal as well as empirical data. So what we said in the criteria was that the measure is modifiable through school-level policies and practices. So as an example, do we want to ask principals and division leaders,

[00:47:29] what policies and practices have you changed in order to realize the academic performance that it is you have sought through for accreditation purposes maybe that's a way to think about um you know kind of the process and how we keep keep focused on the main thing but then drilling down to how

do we get the information about how we assess whether or not it's been positive negative or the consequences have been unintended so that's just one way maybe to think about it

[00:48:00] Yeah, you're making the sausage a whole lot better than I am, because that's ultimately kind of the opportunity I saw was trying to find kind of like our North Star, the things that we could hold ourselves accountable to measuring against that kind of that baseline.

[00:48:18] But then we also had a lot of information that we're seeking and looking for that could drive us in a number of different directions. And so I was trying to find that way of kind of connecting those two. So I like the idea that you said of maybe we're just into the positive, negative and unintended outcomes as a way to do that.

[00:48:37] Yeah. And then if we wanted to think about, you know, kind of a subset of these criteria. So we I will personalize it. I trust that Jen Pavarana and others are going to tell us if the data is reliable and valid.

[00:48:54] I don't really need, I mean, I don't, you know, I'm not an expert there. So I trust that that, so we can, for me, I don't really need to talk about that. But what I would like to hear more about are the, you know, that bullet on policies and practices, this idea of differentiating among schools based on particular groups, Pam, I think that gets to your concern about particular needs of students.

[00:49:21] And then consequently, you know, unfairly, the unfair impact perhaps on one type or group of schools or students. And we can, you know, say those, those learners to Dr. Geron's point. Right, right. So those three bullets, you know, perhaps could help us narrow because I worry that, as you say, we can go in lots of different directions and really not have an answer.

[00:49:47] And it may be that for this period of time, this is our focus, knowing that perhaps subsequently we will want to ask either the same question or we would want to differentiate it a little bit as we get further down the path. So that's just a suggestion.

[00:50:05] Well said, Dr. Wilson. I think having that this time, I think the word you just said rings well with me, at this time. Because if we were further into this accreditation model, then I think that would have other questions. But where we are at this moment, those three things about unintended, positive, and negative outcomes tied to how you described it, said it much better than I did.

[00:50:26] But yes, exactly what you said is what I wasn't trying to say earlier. I think that, and what Emily was talking about in terms of how we gather the qualitative data, that to me is very valuable at this point. I do trust the quantitative data.

[00:50:41] We can get the reports from VDOE staff, but I really hope that we'll take a moment in this committee to spend time really at least intentionally seeking out qualitative data from the stakeholders who have been implementing this and seeing what their thoughts are with regards to those three high buckets.

[00:50:57] Yeah, that's probably going to be one of our largest indicators of whether or not the needle is moving. You know, I apologize again and again, it won't be the last time for my over-engineered mind, but the whole time Dr. Wilson was talking, I was just envisioning this scorecard, you know, really that we're looking at these indicators here, and based on positive, negative, or unintended outcomes, we're kind of measuring ourselves against how well we're doing, and I don't think it needs to be that regimented, but I do see a better way of kind of keep helping us kind of write the course as far as what actually

[00:51:37] are we trying to accomplish, and I actually kind of hear as part of that discussion what in-state looks like in-state means we're able to stand back and look at this at some point in the future and say in a summarizing way how how well good or bad or neutral we're doing in these in these areas and in the neutral or bad what we're doing about it to change it i think this is a very timely committee agreed thanks to i i don't know if that's thanks to dan or thanks to dan and dr

[00:52:15] lane or i don't know who the thankless is due to but uh well we need to be thanking you because you're leading us i need to be thanking whoever at whoever twisted my arm to do it no um okay so all that being said i think that was a good discussion because you know i know for me it kind of helped me kind of understand how we're going to in the conversations i've had offline with emily and dr lane a couple times i think they would quote me as saying well i really want to make sure i want to i really want to see what the committee is i really want to see what committee So, one thing I'm hypersensitive to is your time, and again, it gets back to what information we want to hear.

[00:52:53] So, today, the department has already prepared a presentation for us to conduct a review of Virginia's current accreditation system, and then, in particular, some particular components of it.

[00:53:15] I think that's relevant, highly relevant just from a baseline understanding, educational standpoint. Emily already mentioned that I think in August, the opportunity for us to hear from, and I always forget their acronym, help me out.

[00:53:34] ECS, Education Commission of the States, and we were, just to kind of interrupt for just a moment, at the August meeting, we were planning to bring in ECS to talk about the national perspective and then have our staff walk through all of the different components of the soa for the meeting in august was our plan right so i kind of saw that if i understood you correctly if that that's really the the bulk of that whole meeting right i mean it sounded like that was enough

[00:54:06] information to cover two hours unless i'm absolutely right yeah and what i would just for for the newer board members that haven't read potentially the full soa yet there really is a lot in there that's not just the accreditation system so we wanted you uh we wanted you to see the broader spectrum to see if there were other areas of the soa that you wanted to address and we're somewhat hopeful that you will but we didn't want to really talk a lot about those items until you had seen that conference review right um and then i'm just trying to lay the landscape here of kind

[00:54:44] of what the initial plan on the table right now is right and so after that august in informational session the thought was in september correct me if i'm not if i'm wrong to have a uh update from the department's um covid task team related to this topic was that correct emily yeah so we discussed um potentially having uh the accreditation task force come in and present some of their recommendations um that may the september time frame just based off of this discussion may be a

[00:55:21] little premature um we may want to shift gears to think about more bringing in um you know practitioners to talk about the current system before we get to recommendations on how to make changes to the system that could be a better avenue but i'd certainly leave that up to the committee to decide who they'd like to hear from next i have a question on that um when we think about the covet group that's been working on these adjustments how do we message and separate out this work from the committee as a long-term review of accreditation versus response to what's happening

[00:56:00] now during covet and maybe perhaps some waivers of things that might need to be put in place this year but i envision correct me if i'm wrong kisha help me that this was not about that it was more long-term looking and so i just worry how if we mix it too much i suppose we can i mean just as i was hearing you speak emily i was just thinking about how people might misinterpret what we're trying to do and even when we seek information from stakeholders as we were talking about a minute ago how do we clearly message that we're not asking and we're not a committee of the board to make adjustments to covet necessarily uh because i think that would be the expectations

[00:56:39] of many if we're not clear absolutely and and i should also clarify that while the accreditation task force and um shelly loving rider and julie malik and dr fiber and i were also they were actually the staff leads to that committee so um i'll let them jump in as well but the accreditation task force while it did look at covid related items which as you mentioned should kind of be separate from this committee. They also did have some more long-term recommendations as well, you know, because I think COVID is going to have impacts on the long-term accreditation.

[00:57:15] So I think it would be good to potentially hear from them on those more long-term recommendations than necessarily COVID specific. But I'll also let Shelly or Jen or Julie jump in if they have anything else to add there. Emily, I think you covered it well. They definitely had some interest in making some recommendations about long-term changes based on the cumulative COVID impact. Jen, Julie, you have anything else to add? No, not for me. Thank you for that. I guess I'm

[00:57:52] highly sensitive to living in this COVID world where everything we do is just assumed to always be about COVID. And yes, we have a lot of adjustments we're making to that, but we also have to, I have found on a daily basis having to separate and really intentionally say, no, this is something that has nothing to do with COVID, but we really need to continue to focus on this.

[00:58:10] and this is something that's not. So maybe I'm overly hyper-sensitive, but as I've dealt with that over the last month, it's been very, very challenging for people to mix things and then want to infuse COVID into this conversation. And there are parts, to your point, Emily, that there may be long-term, but how we message that and clarify, I think at least one member of this committee is very important. Absolutely. I agree. Could I make also a suggestion or request, as we're determining from whom we hear about impact about the positive negative unintended

[00:58:49] i know that at the department there are offices that have been speaking of kind of ongoing long term work offices that have been wrapped around um you know impact on students for a long time i think i'm thinking about our our office of equity and they certainly would have i suspect some information that would be useful to us in terms of what they are hearing, seeing, how they are interacting, or what questions they're answering from folks in the field,

[00:59:25] as well as offices that deal with or work with our ELLS students and our faculty and staff and building leaders who are serving students with that particular thing in mind. So I would want to make sure that we are wrapping around, or wrapping into this conversation, any intel we have from department staff who day to day are working through all of this.

[00:59:52] - I think that that touches on a couple of bullets that I did wanna verify would be part of some future presentation. To me that touches on the standards of quality and equity work kind of bullets. How are we making sure that those elements, that body of work and those functional areas that are hyper-

focused around that body of work, how are we making sure that any feedback related to this accreditation model is being captured?

[01:00:25] And so that was one question I had about how do, you know, what are those connection points from a presentation standpoint that we can, do we ask the question differently saying, what is the department doing to ensure that through the standards of accreditation this work is pulled in you know how what's the best approach to making sure we're getting that kind of just intel to make sure that that infrastructure at least isn't is it at least forming if not in place so for me you know certainly i i will leave that to the department to figure out you know how we hear about how we hear what's going on you know whether it is you

[01:01:04] know individuals who are leading in those areas presenting or doing a portion of a presentation or feeding into something, I don't, I'm not suggesting one way or the other, maybe just setting that as a request or an expectation that we're going to certainly hear, you know, that what we hear is full-throated in terms of across the enterprise. So, you know, that's just where I, what I would suggest. And we're happy to do that. Yes, we have that

[01:01:44] data. And we have presentations to highlight some of that work for you. And the board wants to hear that we'll be prepared. Can I share something personal with everyone? We had a school system, and please forgive me for not being able to pull it out. We had a school system with a population of students that were, and there was a phrase that we used for that population of students that they would come in and then they would leave right before graduation, but they they were there for a very short time. And I forget the phrase that we gave them. But when that

[01:02:22] principal and that superintendent came in and did a presentation, that touched me on several different levels about how the SOA is supporting those schools, those challenged schools with migrant populations, with transitional populations. So if we could make sure that we touch base with those groups, high poverty, L population, transitional communities, things like that, and hear from them how the accreditation process has helped them or has hurt them. I would like

[01:03:01] to hear their stories. I would like to hear their qualitative data. I'd like to have those discussions, maybe like Emily, you were talking about with those organizations. To me, that's what I want to hear. And I think, Pam, you're referencing Justice High School and Fair We'll make sure to include them as an opportunity, because I know they had a lot of strong thoughts in Fairfax around how we might think different about, I think the acronym you were looking for was SLIFE students.

[01:03:32] Yes, sir. That was it. Exactly. Thank you. So there's -- That was what I had mentioned last time, so thank you for bringing that up again. Sorry, Keisha. Oh, you're fine. You're fine.

[01:03:47] I'm just going to continue to move the conversation along. There's a couple of other just data points I want to connect and make sure that from a future presentation standpoint that either it's covered or that see if there's consensus from the team that that we still need some that that's part of our action to address one piece is this bullet on complexity of the system um that came up a couple times in our presentation and previous dialogue and you know i don't you know i don't know you know you always set out to go after a project to to address things that you have control over you know and so you so you know i don't know

[01:04:23] where that falls on the side of the fence as far as complexity of the system. But I'm just curious to hear from this group, when we look at what our objectives are, looking at positive, negative, unintended outcomes based on criteria, do we feel that addressing that has a place in this work?

[01:04:44] And if we still need time to figure that out, we leave it on the table. But I just, I'm curious of the team's thoughts. Do you think we would hear some of that as we focus on positive, negative, unintended and we're hearing in response to those prompts, we're hearing from building and division leaders, do you think that's going to be ferreted out through their comments, the complexity of the system and things that might need to be addressed or changed?

[01:05:24] could flesh out as an unintended outcome or something like that potentially in the feedback and if and so if it shows up again basically we could say if it shows up again then yeah let's address it uh we won't necessarily go after it with a spearhead or something like that so well and i think one of the things we um as we were building or the board was building the accreditation model um it became the model itself became perhaps more complex than it might have been

[01:05:58] because of the federal requirements that are overlaid and so and trying to um not duplicate efforts but finding that we have to bifurcate and duplicate or or what appeared what feels like duplication because of the federal mandates that are on that we are responding to i guess the flip side of that is so does is there then a reason to think about then the state requirements I think and I'm processing again out loud part of that answer is but our general assembly or you know

[01:06:33] into some degree um weighs in or has weighed in on what uh it believes uh public education should look like so you know kind of what can we control what can't we control um and and sifting those things out and yeah you know we just thinking about complexity of the system um you know we could also ask in our requests to ecs to talk about how complex potentially virginia system is

[01:07:10] compared to other states and and how you know that could be a good good foray into that as well to get some feedback yeah i think that's a great idea great idea yeah um and then kind of also piggybacking off the alignment with with federal accountability um you all have have asked you know anything that we can provide as a report or just kind of background information in advance we can do that and so um shelly may want to jump in here i don't know if um if we

[01:07:47] have any comparison information already prepared how virginia system aligns with the federal system or if that's some background we could provide in advance of the next meeting to the committee to give you all some more information. Emily, we do have a chart that shows the indicators we use for state accreditation and how they compare to what we use for our ESSA plan. So is that what you're asking in terms of how what we have for accreditation compares to what we use for our ESSA requirements?

[01:08:26] I think that could be helpful, and I'll defer to other committee members if you have specifics of what you're looking for, but I think seeing how our Virginia system aligns with ESSA, you know, if we can do that more as background information than a full presentation, we could easily prepare that for you.

[01:08:44] That would be beneficial. I know for me, if you would provide that as background, like read ahead, that'd be good. And I think I mentioned the last time we talked that initially we did submit our state accreditation system as our ESSA plan, and that was rejected, so you will see some differences in what we ultimately used as our ESSA plan because of the federal requirements.

[01:09:16] We'd be happy to get that to you. Thank you. So I just had just a couple more, again, points to clarify. A lot of this stuff kind of repeats itself, but just a couple of loosens that I still see. I don't see it on here anywhere, but the matrix itself, we, you know, the matrix-based approach, just, you know, I know that in our original presentation, we kind of touched on it on the surface, but we talked about maybe getting a deeper dive into understanding that.

[01:09:47] Do you see that as part of some future packaged presentation and or does the committee see value in understanding that better? if the committee feels pretty solid on that and doesn't see it as about, you know, as something that we need more clarity on, then I'm fine. I'm just making sure that that's the case.

[01:10:18] Dr. Pexton, maybe I'll just provide a little bit of background that may be helpful. So when we were looking at the models initially, really our choices were a matrix model where we had a number of different indicators and that we would provide information on each indicator separately. The other option was an index model where we would have indicators, but we would weight those and come up with an overall rating. The thought at the time was that because we were trying to create a multi-indicator model, that the matrix model better fit that desire. Initially,

[01:10:57] the plan was to just report on each indicator and not have an overall accreditation rating. ultimately we did end up having an overall accreditation rating but the thought was that the matrix model better valued um the board's desire to have multiple indicators as part of accreditation could i ask shelley a question absolutely so shelley i heard you say that the original thought was not to have an overall rating but rather rate each indicator separately

[01:11:35] can you remind us why in the end not necessarily matrix versus uh uh indicate you know not not necessarily that structure but why did we decide that we had to have an overall rating can you remind us of that certainly there are a number of references in in the code that talk about accredited schools and so we were trying to ensure that we also met the requirements of of legislation where there is reference to accreditation the accredited school which

[01:12:11] which indicated that we needed to have an overall rating thanks that helps so other than that overview and thank you for providing that shelly other than that overview does the does the committee feel like we need any additional details in that if not we'll put a pin in that and not you know spend any more time discussing that that model i don't need any more i'm good but i'll talk to others. Yeah, I agree. Maybe we just put it to the side. And then if as we learn more, it seems to be

[01:12:46] something that, you know, has potential to bubble, then we bring it back. But I think at this point, we push it down. Right. I'm satisfied to do that. Me too. So the last two data points that I wanted to talk about on this document, and then I'll be ready to kind of turn things over for the presentation is and then actually I'll be ready to turn it over to the board for any final thoughts as far as inputs to future presentations, but throughout this document, obviously there's a lot of references to various indicators, either more clarity around, you know, an indicator

[01:13:24] or growth measure that's in there, or either a better look at chronic absenteeism in light of what might occur, or there's questions about the criteria that's not in there, look at college career civic readiness index ability or not not not in there but wanting us to kind of revalidate it my whole point is is that teacher quality and third grade measures not there to me you know is there a way to bucket kind of those discussions into to some associated presentation

[01:14:00] how would you recommend maybe emily and dr lane that we kind of address some of those random questions around all these potential measures and or you know validating them i mean i think sorry i'm just i'm trying to think out think out loud um i think we could you know try to pull data like we could work with with jen paivarenna to see you know what data we have

[01:14:38] on some of these other measures um to see if they kind of meet that threshold of valid and reliable and present that information to you if it does meet that threshold to see if that's something you know the board wants to consider and we could also ask those questions of different groups you know when they come in is this something that needs to be added to the system is this a metric that's going to improve student outcomes improve student achievement um is it going to move policies in in your school and school division yeah obviously these are questions that kind of the

[01:15:15] board that as a whole kind of throughout there relative to these indicators or measures so some of it might be you know validated or reconciled from some of that feedback we get from the you know from the from the public feedback and and maybe some of their questions or feedback will harp on certain measures why are they not there why are they written this way or measures this way or so um i just i just was trying to find a way to address a lot of some of the thoughts that were thrown out by the board that seemed to kind of fall in the same category dr pexton if i may it might also be helpful just for staff to recap some of the previous discussions the board had

[01:15:55] around these particular indicators and and why they were not included in 2017. that's a good point because a lot of that was articulated in that in the historical document that emily that you guys provided you know a lot of that was kind of time lined out reading it and then really having someone give you some contextual insight into what you're reading would certainly help so if we took that relative to some of the key topics that are on here and and that might that might help i i think at least for me kind of synthesize the information that's a good idea we we can certainly work that

[01:16:34] into part of the presentation around the overall review of the SOA that we have planned for next month that we can talk about those items. Okay and the last thing I hate to put Dr. Lane on the spot but the last one was just a question that came up kind of between me him and Dan from what I from what I can recall. I'm just kind of keeping inventory of my emails around the subject and there was a question that came up if i'm not mistaken dr lane from dan that talked about as part of this review you know could we move schools to a competency but competency competency

[01:17:12] base rather than age-based uh model and i'm i'm relatively i'm relatively i'm extremely ignorant to the context of that question but dr lane i know that you chimed in on it so i just didn't know if maybe i just wanted to bring it to the to this committee as a thought that a thought bubble that was thrown out in the past yeah and uh it's probably a longer topic than just today but you know the the the notion of uh of of student mastery being the focus rather than a minimum standard

[01:17:51] is very intriguing i think to almost any educator but um i would want to be really clear on what what the board means by competency if that's you know what you're looking for um and i think we'd have to have a lot of public conversation about it and so um i think what i would recommend we start with is uh a presentation and i think shelly could put this together and around what competency based assessment and curriculum look like because the standards would have to go hand in hand with

[01:18:26] that and then a conversation is that what the board really wants to do and then if so how uh you know how this would look and and how it would drive policy and so uh dr pexton what we had

planned for the august meeting was to if you recall review the kind of the mission the vision and the philosophy that the board has around the standards of accreditation that's really the first few chapters of the soa and i uh if if if if this type of if this type of focus becomes a part of that philosophy then i think we were going to develop projects around that to help the board understand how that

[01:19:06] would look and so i think that philosophical discussion we plan to have in august will really drive that conversation so i do want to you know just recap me throwing that out there as you know you know dan's not here to speak to it but i'm really kind of championing that thought on dan's behalf just because it came up and i want to do due diligence by it i i really myself have no position quite yet it's too early for me and from a from an educational standpoint really have

[01:19:42] any kind of position on whether i feel like we need to really bring that into the philosophical discussion or not, but I did want to bring it to the committee's attention that that thought was out there. So this would certainly be the time for the committee members to chime in to say whether or not they feel like that that's relevant. But I also want to do due diligence by Dan.

[01:20:05] So maybe a way to ask that question that broadens it a little bit is to ask the question, are there other models or school structures that may be useful or may help us, help schools achieve in different ways than they are currently, right?

[01:20:38] So that broadens the conversation and doesn't necessarily talk about competency-based versus age-based, but for me, understanding you know what others who study this see and um as they study the topic what might they suggest um would be useful for us to know about all of these various models so maybe that's a different way to think about the question that's not so pigeonholed to you know an either or but let's look at the landscape perhaps i wonder if the ecs could give us that same first could give

[01:21:15] them could give us their perspective on that same from that same lens um yeah i definitely think that that they um we could ask them to do that okay i agree so again i just wanted to do due diligence based on just the initial data that people inputs we got it sounds like to me at least um from from a couple of months standpoint we've got a a reasonable inventory of presentations that

[01:21:53] we could learn from we've got some concepts or thoughts around how we will get some feedback some some some empathy data some real some real time feedback as far as how things what kind of outcomes are occurring um like at some point we can continue wrapping our heads around really how we will answer the questions in those three buckets you know with the with that thumbs up thumbs down or neutral but uh i think we've got a good starting point at least for today build on so um with that emily i i would i would turn the floor over for our presentation on the

[01:22:31] review of the virginia um accreditation yeah so i think and and this may have been a miscommunication on my part we had planned that presentation for the august meeting um and really just wanted to give um give the committee time this month to set the direction but then we added in the two topic areas around um this philosophy and goals and student achievement um to give the board time to to discuss what direction they wanted to go in but it sounds like i think you guys want more

[01:23:05] information before you're able to discuss the direction that that the committee is interested in going in so yeah i'm sorry and please by all means recalibrate my understanding because i did misunderstand that but but the link to the june 17th presentation was for us to kind of go back through

that as a as a team ourselves yeah just for you know my understanding was and i could also be wrong um that that this was really just going to be a time for us to um you guys to ask questions

[01:23:41] and see if there's anything else that that we needed to cover as part of that and then bring you that full soa walk kind of through each section in at our august meeting okay and so for the initial discussion on the committee's philosophies and goals um i i guess i i i guess i i uh perceive that to be uh some sort of initial review or presentation as well but that's not that wasn't your intent and what i thought maybe to save our time here since we have 45 minutes uh if i can

[01:24:17] take over the screen i can point you to a few places in the soa that maybe the board would take some time and review uh if you'll allow me to call it homework uh and and and so you can see a little bit about where we want to go with this and so um i'm going to share my screen emily if i have rights i think i do yep you should have rights so are you seeing lis on my screen yes yes so if you

[01:24:51] go to chapter 131 uh uh of the regulations you'll see that chapter 131 is the regulations establishing the standards for accrediting public schools and what we're going to do with you next time as i scroll down is take you through all 430 sections of the soa now please note that most of them go by tens and so it won't literally be 430 um but and you can see that most of the 300s

[01:25:28] and was repealed and so there will be a lot to skip but you'll see that the soa covers everything from section 390 actually accreditation to waivers applications for uh indicators but then it goes up here into a lot more the the role of the principal the role of staff staffing requirements some on family life education elective courses instructional programs and so this is where the board essentially over time has parked some of that input stuff that is in the older school

[01:26:06] if you will uh accreditation models but this is maybe an area that the board will explore hey maybe we have maybe we want to make meeting this requirement a piece of what determines whether a school is accredited or not in addition to test scores and graduation rates and outcomes now the homework assignment that i would i would give and i'll walk us through it here is essentially to look at sections 10 20 and 30. and i think that if we can get really clear and i'm gonna i'm gonna open these in a minute if we can get really clear on our our purpose our philosophy our goals and

[01:26:46] objectives and our student achievement expectations i think it really sets the tone for what you want to have an accreditation system and so i think it'd be good for you to see while i hopefully can click through this quickly maybe if i stop my video it'll move faster i thought it'd be good for you to see what the board has regulated before in this area and so uh here is here is purpose and so um you know this feels like something that might be a little less uh potentially open to

[01:27:24] change over time but but i think every time the board does this soa you would want to look at it and so provide an essential foundation for educational programs encourage and promote school quality foster public confidence assure recognitions of virginia schools by other institutions of learning determine effectiveness in the standards of quality which we're doing obviously um and and and so on and so forth and so this might be a place where you take some of the work from your comprehensive plan to talk about some of your equity goals and other things and

[01:28:03] embed that in the purpose of the standards of accreditation it might also be a place where you take the work that you did with the profile of a virginia graduate and embed that in the purpose of what we try to do so i'll leave that now and i'll take you to philosophy goals and objectives um and here the board

makes a a strong statement around around philosophy um that you know achieving school quality and continuous improvement are accomplishments dependent

[01:28:37] upon multiple factors goals and objectives to be achieved through these areas include preparation of all students to result graduate have explored and then it goes on uh education should encompass master of creative thinking and the philosophy goals objective school should reflect and come means by which standards of learning and standards of accreditation are achieved the board's objective is to provide an educational foundation that ensures students are ready to be successful in the global economy and so you'll see some of this language speaks to older versions of

[01:29:15] the board's philosophy and may need updating to align to your newer and renewed focus on equity and the profile but the one the one area i would so those were i'm going to do quick i'm going to slow down a little bit in section 30 because the student achievement expectations i think are vastly different in the way i hear the board talk from what's in your regulation right now and this is probably where next month we'll want to get the most clarity from you so today we're not necessarily looking for you to edit in wordsmith obviously live in the meeting but let me take you

[01:29:53] through some of what you state in student achievement expectations so as students should learn the relevant grade level core subject before promotion to the next grade level the division superintendent should certify the division's promotion retention policy does not exclude students from membership in a greater participation of course in which as well as to be administered each school shall have a process to identify and recommend strategies to address the learning behavior communication or development of individual children who are having difficulty in the education setting. So when I read section A, I'll give you a layman's interpretation to it. It has

[01:30:31] a heavy achievement focus and a lower growth focus. And so maybe the board wants to have a conversation about being a little bit more focused on how students grow than whether they meet benchmarks at certain times. Now, the board may think that achievement is the primary expectation and so you can see that you know this whole section is called student achievement expectations we we may want to think about this being student progress expectations or some other term that you come up with then you go on to b in kindergarten through eighth grade where the

[01:31:08] administration of the assessment program is required by the board each student shall be expected to take the following tests take test following instruction excuse me students who are not accelerated shall take and then you get really nuanced on exactly the rules of who takes what tests um and then you talk about basic mastery which is very different from a competency focus so if you know that's a that's a philosophical discussion of the board um you talk about a focus on the four cores and you know i think the board may want to see a more holistic expectation to as

[01:31:47] part of your profile and then you talk about retakes and you talk about recovery and um you You talk about summer school. You talk about applicable tests and when a student is required to take a test.

[01:32:06] And then you talk about how English learners participate in our assessment system. And so what I'm showing you is, even though we did some really innovative work to set out new indicators, our regulation, when it states the purpose and expectations of our system, are very driven still on the SOL test.

[01:32:27] And so, again, I'll ask you to read this and I gave you a very quick span of it. But this is an area where you may want to get really clear as a committee on what you want, because I think that will drive everything else that we do later. And Dr. Paxton, I hope that helps know that that's certainly helped me a lot.

[01:32:47] I do have one follow on clarifying question. I was referring back again to that historical document that you guys provide the background history. A lot of, you know, a majority of that document just is showing the approved changes that were made, which I'm assuming were approved changes that were made to what you were just referencing to some of the sections that you were just referencing to us.

[01:33:13] and if that's the case section 131 definitions for yeah that's the case i guess i'm just about confirming that any major changes to a lot of that language you were reading occurred as a part of this october 2017 revisions yeah right what i would say just reading it quickly i don't know every little change from 2017 but you can you can see that like most policy and regulation it's iterative there was a lot of it that was there before and its sentences were inserted to support

[01:33:50] the work that the board was doing and you can see stuff about retakes and everything else i think that now that we're doing this a little bit more holistically based on the board president's recommendation we may want to look at this philosophy a little bit more holistically as well yeah i'm just trying to confirm and value i understand kind of the wording that you were reading kind of where it originated from and it originated from the body of work and the people and the individuals who were really preparing a lot of the who went through the process that we're now getting an historical perspective on and so they obviously you know put their rubber stamp on

[01:34:28] those words but to your point since things have changed you know some the board has taken on a much more defined stance towards some specific topics and so they certainly would not have considered that in their perspectives but i also and even in you pointing out some of those specific areas I'm also in my mind initially sending a disconnect from some of the even educators as far as the baseline characteristics and it does seem kind of heavily laden with the

[01:34:57] assessment stuff so anyway that was helpful it'll be good to review that more detail any other thoughts or questions from the committee relative to that presentation okay so due to the the the misunderstanding on my part and understanding how my agenda was going to be laid out I'm going to reward you guys with 30 minutes back on your calendar so you're very welcome um thank you leadership you can expect to me as i'm always worried about my people first and want to be

[01:35:37] sensitive to your time now um i i do uh think it was beneficial just to kind of recap some of the discussion that we had today um i think from an objective standpoint and starting there and referencing some of the original characteristics and criteria that the standards of accreditation as they are today I think I think we all agree that that's a good place for us to kind of start as far as saying this is where

[01:36:12] they left off how far off of that path our way are they and I think we kind of came to the consensus that we would we would measure barometer based on some kind of loose criteria of positive income outcomes negative and unintended and and and through a series of structured presentations we feel like on the other side we're gonna be really being able to answer those questions of whether or not we're at least as a part of this pulse check on track to seeing

[01:36:49] more positive income outcomes or more of the intended outcomes that was originally planned seeing as much as possible so we'll spend next month the majority of next month will really be just an information session we will or will not get some pre-read information I think there was a request about getting some information on how our standards align to ESSA and state and all that so we'll get some information on that. Dr. Lane gave us a homework assignment to go

[01:37:26] look over those first three sections of that of that law and that code just to make sure we've got a good baseline understanding of for the review next week. We will also hear from that's also next in August is when we'll also hear from ecs if i'm not mistaken right as part of the second part of the presentation so um what else am i missing emily so my list is a written rep homework report from from us on align our state

[01:38:03] alignment with the federal system a presentation from staff on all of the aspects of the soa to walk through each each portion of it because it also includes things like graduation requirements you know, other instructional programs. We'll have a ECS presentation that's going to provide a national perspective and some of those topics are going to include, you know, what are some other indicators in other states that kind of look at the matrix approach. Is that an approach

[01:38:37] that happens a lot in other states or are there other approaches to it? Also a perspective on competency-based education and is that happening in other states as well as well as just kind of that national perspective on accreditation and so we'll work with them on that and I think that's going to take up a big chunk of time in August and then I think in September you know we can start working on bringing in some different kind of Virginia perspectives for you all to think about

[01:39:10] um and dr lane and i as well as other staff can can think think through how um how we bring those folks in you know what questions do we pose to them kind of those the pros and cons of different consequences um and and how we go about that very good and uh dr and then while i have you go ahead dr lane i was just saying i just dropped in the chat for everyone a link to the entire soa and so you may want to bookmark that because that will be your life in this committee for the next

[01:39:47] months to year and so just thought that that's a that's a good reference point for us to always go back to in our work sorry Emily go ahead that's okay and I'm happy to email those links out as well and I can even in your electronic board book I could even create kind of a homework page if we wanted to do that where I can put different important links for you all and then upload presentations as they're available for you to take a look at in advance appreciate that and then did we want to go ahead and select the date um for the august meeting i sent out a survey

[01:40:26] and i have two options that i wanted to kind of pull the group on yeah i was going to ask if we had that finalized yet so we we have narrowed it down to two options that seem to work um with the majority, but just wanted to get feedback. So the first option is Wednesday, August 26th at 1 p.m.

[01:40:51] And again, we're trying to keep all of these meetings to about two hours. Is that a thumbs up from everybody? I can do that day if the other day is not better. And then the other option was Thursday the 27th at 10 a.m. That day's better for me. That day works for me too. Okay Pam what about

[01:41:22] for you? Are you saying the 27th at 10 a.m.? Yes ma'am. I'm open right now. And Dr. Wilson? Yes I can do that. All right so do we want to go with the 27th at 10 a.m.? Yes. All right well I will send out a hold on to everyone's calendar and that's for two hours yes thank you all right um so if

[01:42:00] there's not any other link final thoughts or questions as far as our path forward i appreciate everybody's time today and contributions to the dialogue looking forward to growing smarter about this whole process together and appreciate emily and the team there at the department and supporting us along the way. So thank you very much. Thanks, everybody. Thanks.



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